Question 4: Long Essay Question, US Foreign Policy and Changes in the World — 6 points

General Scoring Notes

- Except where otherwise noted, each point of these rubrics is earned independently; for example, a student could earn a point for evidence without earning a point for thesis/claim.
- **Accuracy:** The components of these rubrics require that students demonstrate historically defensible content knowledge. Given the timed nature of the exam, essays may contain errors that do not detract from their overall quality, as long as the historical content used to advance the argument is accurate.
- **Clarity:** Exam essays should be considered first drafts and thus may contain grammatical errors. Those errors will not be counted against a student unless they obscure the successful demonstration of the content knowledge, skills, and practices described below.

Evaluate how United States foreign policy responded to changes in the world from 1890 to 1930.

© 2025 College Board

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row A **Thesis/Claim** **(0–1 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Responds to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis/claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: • Are not historically defensible. • Only restate or rephrase the prompt. • Do not respond to the prompt. • Do not establish a line of reasoning. • Are overgeneralized.	**Responses that earn this point:** • Provide a historically defensible thesis or claim about how United States foreign policy responded to changes in the world from 1890 to 1930. The thesis or claim must either provide some indication of the reason for making that claim OR establish categories of the argument.
	Examples that do not earn this point: **Provide a restatement of the prompt** • *"United States foreign policy responded to changes in the world from 1890 to 1930."* **Provide a historically defensible claim, but do not establish a line of reasoning** • *"The United States fought the Spanish-American War."* **Do not respond to the prompt** • *"The United States economy grew tremendously during this period."*	**Examples that earn this point:** **Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt** • *"Over the forty-year period between 1890 and 1930, global conflicts pushed the United States to alternate between foreign policies of isolationism and interventionism."* **Establish a line of reasoning that evaluates the topic of the prompt with analytic categories** • *"Between 1890 and 1930, the United States sought to establish itself as a world power by protecting the Western Hemisphere from European influences, expanding American business influences in foreign territories, and fighting against global threats to democracy."* **Establish a line of reasoning** • *"The United States adopted a more active foreign policy because it wanted to gain global influence."* [Minimally acceptable thesis/claim]
	Additional Notes: • The thesis or claim must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion (which may not be limited to the first or last paragraphs). • The thesis or claim must identify a relevant development(s) in the period, although it is not required to encompass the entire period.	

© 2025 College Board

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	
Row B Contextualization **(0–1 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Describes a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes	
	Responses that do not earn this point: • Provide an overgeneralized statement about the time period referenced in the prompt. • Provide context that is not relevant to the prompt. • Provide a passing phrase or reference.	**Responses that earn this point:** • Accurately describe a context relevant to United States foreign policy from 1890 to 1930**.**
	Examples that do not earn this point: **Do not provide context relevant to the topic of the prompt** • *"Between 1848 and 1890 the influence of the women's movement grew."* **Provide a passing reference** • *"After 1900, foreign policy changed further."*	**Examples of relevant context that earn this point include the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided:** • George Washington's Farewell Address • Westward expansion • Civil War • Reconstruction • The Industrial Revolution • Immigration from Asia, southern and eastern Europe • New Deal • Second World War • Cold War **Example of acceptable contextualization:** • *"George Washington's Farewell Address encouraged Americans to stay out of foreign alliances."* • *"During the nineteenth century the United States expanded west across North America."* [Minimally acceptable contextualization]
	Additional Notes: • The response must describe broader historical events, developments, or processes that occur before, during, or continue after the time frame of the question that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. • To earn this point, the context provided must be more than a phrase or reference.	

© 2025 College Board

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row C **Evidence** **(0–2 points)**	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Provides specific examples of at least **two** pieces of evidence relevant to the **topic** of the prompt.	**2 points** Supports an **argument** in response to the prompt using at least **two** pieces of specific and relevant evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: • Identify a single piece of evidence. • Provide evidence that is not relevant to the topic of the prompt. • Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt. • Repeat information that is specified in the prompt. **Examples that do not earn points:** **Provide evidence that is outside the time period or region specified in the prompt** • *"The Monroe Doctrine was established to keep European influence out of the Western Hemisphere."*	**Responses that earn 1 point:** • Identify at least two specific historical examples relevant to United States foreign policy from 1890 to 1930. **Examples of evidence that are specific and relevant include the following (two examples required):** • Imperialism / Anti-imperialism • "Closing of the Frontier" • Spanish-American War • Philippine-American War • Puerto Rico • Annexation of Hawaii • Theodore Roosevelt • Roosevelt Corollary • Gentlemen's Agreement • Dollar Diplomacy • Woodrow Wilson • First World War • League of Nations • Treaty of Versailles • First Red Scare • National Origins Act • Isolationism **Example of a statement that earns one point for evidence:** • *"After the Spanish-American War, imperialists promoted the annexation of overseas territories such as the Philippines."*	**Responses that earn 2 points:** • Use at least two specific historical examples to support an argument regarding how United States foreign policy responded to changes in the world from 1890 to 1930. **Examples that successfully support an argument with evidence:** • *"The acquisition and annexation of island territories abroad following the Spanish-American War expanded and created a United States presence abroad, making the United States government more involved in global affairs."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how the annexation of island territories increased United States involvement in the world] • *"United States politicians like President Theodore Roosevelt sought to increase United States influences over Latin American countries with such foreign policy platforms as the Roosevelt Corollary to the Monroe Doctrine in 1905."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how United States presidents sought to increase influence in Latin America] • *"The First World War thrust the United States out of its desired isolationist tendencies, allowing politicians like President Woodrow Wilson to take a leadership role in international affairs."* [Uses evidence to support an argument about how the United States turned away from isolationism during the First World War]
	Additional Notes: • Typically, statements credited as evidence will be more specific than statements credited as contextualization. • If a response has a multipart argument, then it can meet the threshold of two pieces of evidence by giving one example for one part of the argument and another example for a different part of the argument, but the total number of examples must still be at least two.		

© 2025 College Board

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria		
Row D Analysis and Reasoning Complex Understanding (0–2 points)	**0 points** Does not meet the criteria for one point.	**1 point** Uses historical reasoning [e.g. comparison, causation, continuity and change] to frame or structure an argument that addresses the prompt.	**2 points** Demonstrates a complex understanding of the historical development that is the focus of the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.
	Decision Rules and Scoring Notes		
	Responses that do not earn points: • May include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument. • May assert the use of historical reasoning but does not use it to frame or structure an argument.	**Responses that earn 1 point:** • Must demonstrate the use of historical reasoning to frame or structure an argument about how United States foreign policy responded to changes in the world from 1890 to 1930. The reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking specificity.	**Responses that earn 2 points:** May demonstrate a complex understanding through sophisticated argumentation that is relevant to the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways, such as: • Explaining multiple themes or perspectives to explore complexity or nuance; OR • Explaining multiple causes or effects, multiple similarities or differences, or multiple continuities or changes; OR • Explaining both cause and effect, both similarity and difference, or both continuity and change; OR • Explaining relevant and insightful connections within and across periods or geographical areas. These connections should clearly relate to an argument that responds to the prompt. May demonstrate a complex understanding through effective use of evidence relevant to an argument that addresses the prompt. This may be done in a variety of ways that might include: • Explaining how multiple pieces of specific and relevant evidence [at least **four**] support a nuanced or complex argument that responds to the prompt; OR • Using evidence effectively to demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of different perspectives relevant to the prompt.
	Examples that do not earn points: **May include evidence but offer no reasoning to connect the evidence to an argument** • *"The First Red Scare occurred in the early twentieth century."*	**Using a historical reasoning process to frame or structure an argument could include:** • Explaining how disillusionment with the outcome of the First World War contributed to isolationist sentiment. • Discussing how advocacy for imperialism caused debates over the role of the United States in world affairs. **Example of acceptable use of historical reasoning:** • *"Foreign policy approaches such as Dollar Diplomacy contributed to increased United States international influence, as it projected economic*	**Demonstrating a complex understanding might include any of the following, if appropriate elaboration is provided:** • A response may argue that the growth of United States involvement overseas was a response to growing competition with imperialist European powers for economic influence. It then argues that United States growth as a world power was primarily motivated by desire to spread American national ideals and protect democratic values overseas, as during the First World War and Woodrow Wilson's involvement in negotiating the Treaty of Paris. [Explains multiple themes] • A response may argue that the motivations for changes in United States foreign policy between 1890 and 1930 were similar. It compares United States Open Door policy in China, growing business influence in Latin America, and imperialism in the Pacific, arguing that

© 2025 College Board

		power over other countries." [Indicates a cause of increased United States global influence]	all of these actions furthered the economic growth of the United States. [Explains connections across geographical areas]
	Additional Notes: • To earn the first point for analysis and reasoning, the response must use historical reasoning to structure a response to the prompt, although the reasoning might be uneven or imbalanced, or the evidence may be overly general or lacking in specificity. • This complex understanding must be part of the argument and may be demonstrated in any part of the response. • While it is not necessary for this complex understanding to be woven throughout the response, it must be more than merely a phrase or reference.		

© 2025 College Board